



First Insights

Global Markets Research

15 May 2026

Foreign Exchange - Asia ex-Japan

Xi-Trump summit supports CNH outperformance

We maintain our short USD/CNH recommendation.

Trump's state visit to China (13-15 May) has been broadly constructive, and we view these as supportive of our CNH outperformance view. While we see a risk of the stronger USD backdrop temporarily impeding the downtrend in USD/CNH, we continue to believe any potential upside is limited and that risks to this trade remain asymmetric. We maintain our **short USD/CNH** position with a modest conviction level of 3/5, targeting 6.60 (~3% gains) by end-August 2026. Our RMB outperformance stance is about **more than just the leaders' summit creating a constructive backdrop** for US-China relations in coming months; it is also a reflection of our favorable views around China's capital flows, political/policy developments and relative competitiveness of China/RMB.

Below, we compiled some key comments and developments from the US-China meetings, but there are likely to be more details emerging and possibly some clarification in the near term.

On trade and investment:

- Trump said (*Fox News*, 14 May) that **China has agreed to purchase soybeans, energy and order 200 Boeing jets**, and he added that "Boeing wanted 150, they got 200". This deal still **marks China's first major Boeing order since 2017**, and also represents a de-escalation after China suspended Boeing jet deliveries in April 2025 (*Reuters*, 15 April 2025).
- US Trade Representative Greer stated "an agreement for **double-digit billion purchases of ags** over the next three years, per year... **not just soybeans, that's everything else**" (*Bloomberg*, 15 May).
- Separately, *Bloomberg* (14 May) also reported that China has **renewed import licences** for many US beef plants that are normally valid for five years.
- *Reuters* (14 May) reported that the **US cleared H200 chip sales to ten China firms**, including Alibaba, Tencent and Bytedance. While the US previously approved H200 chip sales to China, sales of these chips have stalled, as Chinese firms pulled back after guidance from Beijing.
- US Treasury Secretary Bessent said in a CNBC interview (14 May) that there was an idea to **remove US tariffs on about USD30bn worth of Chinese goods** "for non-critical areas, and areas that we're not trying to reshore."
- Bessent also said at the same interview that US and China are discussing a mechanism for a "**Board of Investment**" that will be responsible for [Chinese] investment in non-sensitive areas", and bypass the US Committee on Foreign Investments processes.
- Related to investments, Xi said "China will only **open its door wider**. U.S. businesses are deeply involved in China's reform and opening up" (*Xinhua*, 14 May). Chinese Premier Li Qiang also told US business executives that **China welcomes more foreign companies** with promise of stable and open policies (*Xinhua*, 14 May).
- In our view, these appear to be efforts to slow or even the reverse the process trade and investment decoupling between these two major economies.

On US-China relations:

- Xi emphasized (*Xinhua*, 14 May) that he has "agreed with President Trump on a new vision of building a **constructive China-U.S. relationship** of strategic stability... [which] will provide **strategic guidance for China-U.S. relations over the next three**

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years and beyond”.

- Trump also noted very good relationship between the US and China, and committed to working with Xi to “strengthen communication and cooperation... and make the **bilateral relations better than ever before**” (*Xinhua*, 14 May).
- Trump also extended an invitation to Xi and his wife Peng Liyuan for a **White House visit on 24 September 2026** (*Bloomberg*, 14 May).
- In our view, improving communication and personal ties between the two world leaders should help reduce the risk of an unintended escalation of tensions.

On Iran and Taiwan:

- On the Iran situation, the media cited a White House readout (*Bloomberg*, 14 May) that both sides agreed the **Strait of Hormuz must remain open** to support the free flow of energy, that **China opposed the militarization of the Strait and any effort to charge a toll for its use**, and that Iran should **never obtain a nuclear weapon**. Trump also said that “President Xi would like to see a deal made. He would like to see a deal made. And he did offer, he said if I can be of any help at all I would like to be of help” (*SCMP*, 15 May).
- That said, the Foreign Ministry in Beijing issued a statement (*15 May*) regarding Iran which **avoided explicit statements** on whether Iran should obtain a nuclear weapon, or on Iranian effort to charge a toll for the use of the Strait. Specifically, the statement proposed to “reach a solution that **takes into account the concerns of all parties** on issues such as the Iranian nuclear issue”.
- On the Taiwan issue, President Xi stressed that the Taiwan question is the most important issue in China-US relations, and “Taiwan Independence” and “Peace Across Taiwan Strait” are incompatible (*Bloomberg*, 14 May). Interestingly, the White House readout on 14 May **avoided comments on Taiwan**.

Please see *Strategy portfolio update* (7 May 2026) for our full portfolio.

Appendix A-1

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